In the 1990s, members of an additional unit began to adopt the definition of themselves as combatants, though they did not work in target countries. Previously, they had been simply called Mossad employees, but because they wanted to differentiate themselves by the special operational character of their work, they adopted the title of "combatants." I did not object to this development, as I saw in it the aspiration of one group of employees to emulate another. In terms of risk, the combatants in the unit in which Sylvia served face matters of life and death. The others risk "only" long prison terms. Members of both of these units are the "tip of the spear"—they are at the forefront of the Mossad's operational activities.

The expectations, qualities, and skills demanded of Mossad combatants are the highest on any given scale of any occupation, profession, or job.

In the world of HUMINT, there is a dividing line that is never crossed between the *katza* (field intelligence officer) and the agent. The former is Israeli and Jewish, the latter is not. The former is motivated by a belief in the ideal and justness of Zionism in the Land of Israel, as well as the desire to make a contribution in the course of self-realization. The latter is driven by material motives, despair, or a desire to avenge his homeland and/or the people who wronged him.

The first thing to be derived from this comparison is the degree of trust the system has in the combatant and the agent. Trust in the combatant is unreserved, unconditional, absolute, and final. Trust in the agent is based on the principle of "respecting him while suspecting him."

A few words about operating combatants.

Over many years of operational activity, the Mossad, like other serious Western intelligence services, developed a doctrine of individual operation, that is, a runner and a combatant. The strictest among us were careful to maintain the ratio of one runner for one combatant. Others, sometimes because of financial considerations, put one runner in charge of a small number of combatants operating within the same undercover infrastructure. This doctrine did not come out of nowhere or as a result of the whim of one commander or another. Behind it stood a profound ideology and substantial considerations.

The threshold requirements of combatants are an array of qualities and skills, the most demanding of any profession or occupation one can think of. Their training period is much longer than any other in the field of intelligence. Their "need to know" level is the most constrained. The